to be for six weeks, but it got extended to nearly six months, due to clearances not forthcoming from the MHA, under whom the Assam Rifles function for administrative purposes. When the orders did come, the names and locations had been interchanged. I was to go as the IGAR (N) and Rajeev as the IGAR (S), with both of us to assume our appointments in July 2013.

Since Lt Gen KJ Singh had just taken over, he was out on reconnaissance whenever the weather permitted. He would be out two to three times a week, leaving early in the morning and coming back by noon, as flying in the valleys of Sikkim was restricted to the morning hours due to meteorological reasons. On return, he would call for a staff conference and pass a flurry of orders, before departing for the day. As the COS, it then became my responsibility to follow through on these orders and make sure they were implemented. Lt Gen KJ Singh was a hard taskmaster who wanted results and who did not really care much for, or get bogged down by, paperwork or procedures. If he wanted something done, it had to be done and it was our job as the staff to find a way. Initially, he thought that I would just be 'marking-time' at Sukna, waiting for my posting, but soon realized that I was getting the job done and we developed a close understanding and rapport. So much so that towards the end of my tenure, I could even tell him upfront to stop giving us new tasks at such a frenetic pace, as the documentation and accounting were suffering and we might end up with some serious audit objections. He was very fond of making things: a sentry post here, a decorative entrance gate there, so we used to jokingly refer to ourselves as the 'KJ Construction Company'.[1]

A little over five months after reporting to Sukna, it was time to move again. Nagaland was once again a field posting,

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